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Buying or selling a historic Chicago home? Five things to know.

1 **Check for landmark status**
Homes in Chicago Landmark districts, like the Astor Street District, need Commission on Chicago Landmarks review for many exterior changes. Know before you buy or renovate.

2 **Inspect the bones**
Ask about wiring, plumbing and lead service lines, masonry and tuckpointing, and slate or original roofs. Old systems are fixable when you price them in.

3 **Price the details**
Original millwork, plaster, leaded glass and fireplaces add value that standard comparables can miss. One-of-a-kind homes need a well-supported price.

4 **Insure for history**
Replacing historic materials can cost more. Talk to your insurer about replacement cost before you close.

5 **Ask about incentives**
Some qualifying rehabs of historic homes may be eligible for property tax incentives. Ask me where to start.

Matthew La Rose

REALTOR® · HISTORIC HOME SPECIALIST

773.999.8120 · mlarosehomes@gmail.com

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